

ALSO ON The Sony PlayStation 2

- 1 Amplitude
- 1 Virtua Fighter 4
- 1 Tekken 5
- 1 WWE SmackDown! Here Comes the Pain
- 1 Dragon Quest VIII: Journey of the Cursed King
- 1 Gran Turismo 4
- 1 And many, many, many more

piece of complex stealth mechanics, and uses a cinematic presentation to tell a surprisingly atypical tale. It is at times self-deprecating, sometimes tongue-in-cheek, but *always* absorbing, peppered with intense boss battles against characters such as The Pain, The Fear, and The End. The game is set in a jungle and emphasises camouflage. To which end, MGS3 allows you to apply face paint and slip into various garbs. But even here, the game can't help poking fun at itself: it allows you to wear a fake crocodile head and even a Naked, err... skin, for *Rambo*-style gaming. The best bit is perhaps the Snake vs. Monkey mini-game, which pits the lead character against monkeys from the game *Ape Escape*—with an objective to capture all the monkeys using a stun gun.

MICROSOFT XBOX

It is difficult to recommend a game for the Xbox. Except for *Ninja Gaiden*, which is reason enough to own the console. The Xbox has few exclusive games, and fewer worth playing. Today, all the good titles on the Xbox are also available on the PC. So here's the deal: if you don't have a computer worthy of running current-generation games, buy an Xbox. Most of the multi-platform titles also look best on this console. Plus you can enjoy the few exclusives...

Ninja Gaiden Black

This game lets you play as a Ninja! Nay, as The Ninja—Ryu Hayabusa, who kicks derrières and takes names, and may or may not chew bubblegum while doing it. *Ninja Gaiden Black* is a game of such epic coolness that your fingers will numb to its manic button-dance, your tongue will wallow limply as you execute its savory combos, your eyes will pop



out with fear as yet another boss battle ensues, and you will dance in visceral joy at your victories. With a deep, satisfying, and varied combat system, an unforgiving range of battles and plenty of replay elements, *Ninja Gaiden Black* is the reason to own an Xbox. Yes, it *is* that good. Why are you still here, you ninja dog! Go scurry forth and buy this game, and then the console. Hyaaaaayah!

FarCry Instincts

FarCry Instincts takes the much-loved PC game over to the Xbox, and does so with style. With a completely revamped engine, the game is a *tour-de-force* on the Xbox: it is certainly one of, if not *the* best looking, game on the console. If you haven't played the game on the PC due to hardware limitations, do pick up this version. For those not in the know, *FarCry* puts you into a lush tropical jungle, and is a first-person shooter. The



pace of the action is impeccable—its tempo rises and falls: one moment you are all stealth, the next you are Rambo let loose. The game also mixes guns, jungle traps, special animal traits, and vehicles. You can control jet skis, hovercrafts, hand gliders and Humvees, for some drive-by shooting and for traversing the enormous levels that the game throws at you. Great levels, dual-wielding of weapons, varied enemies, vehicles, beautiful graphics, well-paced action—*Instinct* delivers!

Forza Motorsport

Forza is Microsoft's answer to the *Gran Turismo* series on the PS2. These are *not* the arcade driving games aimed at wimps, but are simulators of everything on four wheels. *Forza*, for instance, lets you drive more than 200 cars from 60 manufacturers. The game throws in a varied mix of tracks as well—from real-world racing tracks to tight street races to fictional courses. Though it's a simulator, the game balances skill well, and is accessible to both newcomers as well as veterans of car mechanics. Perhaps the best feature of the game is the level of customisation it allows on your ride through paint jobs, vinyls and decals. The game also features visible car damage, reflected in the performance of the vehicle. Finally, not only does the game look good, as any Xbox exclusive does, but also sounds great: the roar of your opponent's